

SKITCH & GRIP BOODLE

EPISODE 05 — OPEN ROAD, CLOSED LOOP





AS THE CONVERTIBLE
PULLS OUT OF THE DRIVEWAY...



AT THE SAME MOMENT,
UNNOTICED...



AND JUST LIKE THAT...



SOME ROADS
DON'T LEAD
ANYWHERE.

THAT'S THE
POINT.



GRIP:
SOMETHING
CALM. EASY
LISTENING.

SKITCH:
NAH. LET'S
MIX IT UP.

BOODLE:
LOUDER!
LOUDER!
LOUDER!



...you're listening to
Peaceful Horizons...
where calm lives...

CLICK!

You're tuned to
Capital Rush—
turn it UP—

CLICK!

This is Night Howl...
for those who
run with the dark...

CLICK!

You're listening to
Sunny Pop! Keep
smiling!



>SIGH<

JUST...
PICK
SOMETHING
AND LEAVE
IT.

WHERE'S
THE FUN IN
THAT?



VRRRRMMMM

DIFFERENT
VIBES.
SAME ROAD.







WELCOME TO
MILEPOST 23! WHAT CAN
I CALL Y'ALL?

I'VE GOT NAMES
FOR YOU—INSTANTLY.



YOU'RE
"GRIP."

LOOKS LIKE YOU CAN
HANDLE ANYTHING AND
HOLD IT TOGETHER.



YOU'RE
"SKITCH."

QUICK, CLEVER,
A LITTLE WILD—AND
IMPOSSIBLE TO MISS.



AND YOU'RE
"BOODLE!"

SMALL, ROUND,
ADORABLE, AND UP TO
SOMETHING (ALWAYS).



NICE SETUP
YOU GOT THERE.

THANKS. SHE'S
A SMOOTH RIDE.

APPRECIATE
THE TASTE.



APPRHAXE
THE TASTE.

YOU HAVE
GOOD EYES.

JUST PASSIN'
THROUGH.

MAY YOUR ROADS
TREAT YOU KIND.



GOOD COFFEE.
GOOD COMPANY.
DANG GOOD
NICKNAMES.

BOODLE
LIKES IT
HERE!

ANOTHER ROAD. ANOTHER TABLE.
ANOTHER STORY TO ADD TO THE COLLECTION.

I-80 WESTBOUND
MILES CITY, WYOMING

45 MINUTES
AND 17 QUESTIONS
LATER...

GOOD AFTERNOON.
LICENSE, REGISTRATION,
AND PROOF OF
INSURANCE.

Zzz...



OF COURSE,
OFFICER.
TAKE YOUR
TIME.

THANK YOU.
JUST GOING TO
VERIFY A FEW
DETAILS.

STANDARD
PROCEDURE.

NOTHING
PERSONAL.

»SIGH«
THE "STANDARD
PROCEDURE"
IS THE SIZE OF
A PHONE BOOK.
WHAT A TIME
TO BE ALIVE.



LET'S SEE HERE...
REGISTRATION... CHECK.
INSURANCE... CHECK.
ID MATCHES... CHECK.
VEHICLE WEIGHT...
WITHIN LIMITS.
TIRE TREAD... LEGAL.
HEADLIGHTS...
FUNCTIONAL.
TAIL LIGHTS...
FUNCTIONAL.
TURN SIGNALS...
FUNCTIONAL.
HORN...
FUNCTIONAL.
SEATBELTS...
BUCKLED.
...

I MEAN,
COME ON.
WE COULD'VE
BEEN IN
DENVER BY
NOW.

LOOK—
THERE THEY
GO.

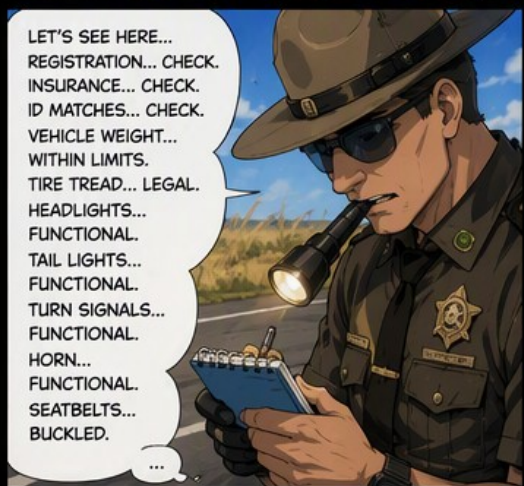
OF COURSE.

PATIENCE,
SKITCH.
PATIENCE.

WE'RE
BUILDING
KARMA.

OR AT LEAST
THAT'S WHAT
I KEEP TELLING
MYSELF.

Zzz...



SEE YA,
SUCKERS!
~♡

MM-HMM.
NEXT...



*ESTIMATED TIME REMAINING: 37 MINUTES

NORTHERN RIDGE
WINDHEART PASS
LATE AFTERNOON

HA!
LOOK AT 'EM.
STILL THINK
THEY CAN OUTRUN
US?

C'MON, GRIP!
PUT THE PEDAL
DOWN! SHOW
OFF A LITTLE!

YOU'RE
TOO GOOD
TO LET THEM
THINK THEY'RE
WINNING?

OR JUST
SCARED TO
BREAK A
SWEAT?

HRM...
MAYBE.

NO.
NOT TODAY.

I'LL SHOW
THEM.



HOLD
ON!



WOOHOO!
WINDY!
RUSTLY!
TASTY!

HANG
ON
TIGHT!

GRIP'S CAR WASH TRILOGY

THREE ATTEMPTS.
THREE DISASTERS.
ONE **VERY** WET FOX.



1



2

THE STUCK
BRUSH



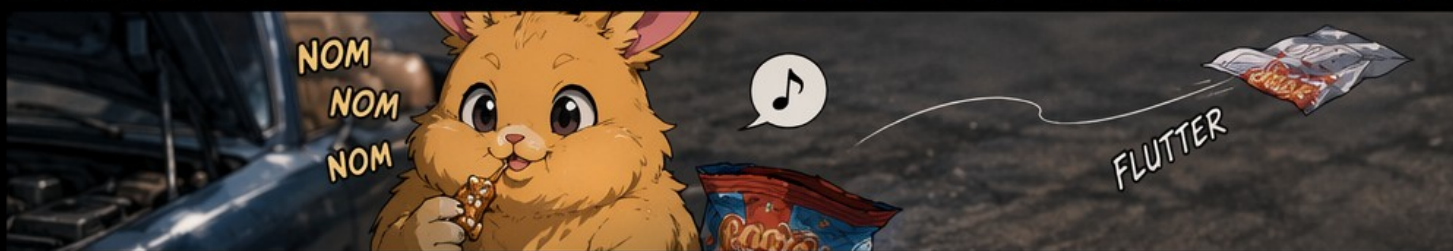
3

THE ACCIDENTAL
REWASH



SOUTHERN HIGHWAY 12
BETWEEN SILVERREST
AND DUSTWOLD

14:37



SOUTHBOUND HIGHWAY 87.
SOMEWHERE BETWEEN
NOWHERE AND
GOOD JUDGMENT.



YEP. FUEL
LINE'S SULKIN'.
NOT BROKEN...
JUST TIRED.

KIND OF
LIKE ALL OF US
SOMETIMES.

THING ABOUT
THE ROAD, KID...
SHE GIVES AND
SHE TAKES.
BUT SHE ALWAYS
KEEPS SCORE.

YOU DON'T OWE
HER MONEY.
YOU OWE HER
A FAVOR.
SOMEDAY.
SOMEWHERE.
THAT'S JUST...
BALANCE.

THANK YOU.
I'LL PAY IT
FORWARD.

BOODLE
OFFERS THIS
SNACK OF
GRATITUDE!

MAY IT FUEL
YOUR JOURNEY
WITH JOY!

HEH.
THAT'S THE
BEST KIND OF
FUEL THERE
IS, KIDDO.

BLESS YOUR
LITTLE HEART.
'SIDES...
I GOT A SOFT
SPOT FOR
RABBITS.

YOU JUST
SAVED OUR
TAILS.

SERIOUSLY...
THANK YOU.
BIG TIME.

THAT'LL DO
JUST FINE.
DRIVE SAFE,
NOW.



KEEP THE BALANCE.





SOME STOPS AREN'T ON THE MAP.
BUT THEY'RE THE ONES YOU REMEMBER.



RIVAL
CREW.
SAME
ROAD.



SIDE MIRROR.
OBSESSIVELY
RE-ADJUSTED.



ONE PASSENGER.
COMPLETELY
UNBOtherED.



TRUNK LID.
REFUSES TO
STAY SHUT.



MAP. HALF-HIDDEN.
HALF-HEARTED.
HALF-USEFUL.



TAILS OF ELYSIUM

CHAPTER 18: QUIET NIGHTS

SOME NIGHTS
DON'T NEED WORDS.

JUST GOOD COMPANY,
WARM AIR, AND
SOMETHING PLAYING
IN THE BACKGROUND.

*Elysian
Drive-In*
+ Since 1967 +



NOT EVERY STORY
NEEDS A FIGHT.

SOME ARE JUST...
LIKE THIS.

STORY & ART BY NYXEN
TAILS OF ELYSIUM © 2024
WWW.TALESOFELYSIUM.COM